



CALIBRATION 101 FOR ESTIMATORS

# When does this car need a calibration?

The estimator sheet from Mark Fowler, owner of Absolute ADAS. Sensor map, line picker, the table, and a Subaru rule you need.



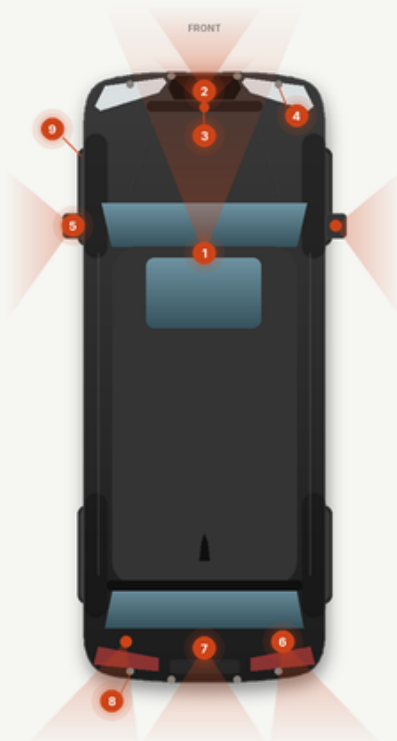
**Absolute ADAS**

Save it. Send it to your estimator.



## WHERE THE SENSORS LIVE

Nine spots. Move the part, move the aim.



Drawn as a RAV4, the car we calibrate most.

- 1 Forward camera**  
moved by: windshield
- 2 Front radar**  
moved by: grille, emblem, beam
- 3 Front grille camera**  
moved by: grille, emblem, front cover
- 4 Front park sensors**  
moved by: bumper cover
- 5 Mirror cameras**  
moved by: mirror, door
- 6 Blind spot radars**  
moved by: rear cover, quarter
- 7 Rear camera**  
moved by: liftgate, tailgate
- 8 Rear park sensors**  
moved by: rear cover
- 9 Wheels, suspension**  
moved by: alignment, tires, lift



THE 60-SECOND ANSWER

If the repair touched any of these, plan on a calibration.

- Windshield R&R, camera off the glass
- Front bumper cover, grille, emblem, beam
- Rear bumper cover, rear body, quarter
- Side mirror that has a camera in it
- Liftgate or tailgate with a camera
- Alignment, struts, springs, tires, lift
- Any ADAS sensor, camera, or bracket
- Airbag deployed: structure moved

**Subaru with EyeSight: any collision, anywhere. Next slide.**



## THE SUBARU RULE

# Subaru with EyeSight: any collision repair gets a calibration.

Not just glass. A hit anywhere can tilt the body a fraction of a degree, and the stereo camera sees it. Subaru bulletin 18-231-23 has us check body angle with a digital gauge before the cal.

**Write it on every Subaru collision RO.  
Spec OE glass. Save the second trip.**



**RED FLAG · WINDSHIELD**

# New glass, new aim.

The forward camera is glued to the windshield. Every glass R&R is a forward camera calibration. Aftermarket glass fails more often than OE, and Subaru says genuine glass only.

Ask your cal shop:

**"Is this OE glass, and does the shop know it is a camera car?"**



RED FLAG · FRONT BUMPER, GRILLE, BEAM

# The radar looks through the cover.

Front radar sits behind the emblem or grille and rides on the bumper beam. Pull the grille, refinish the cover, replace the beam: the radar moved. Too many coats cut the signal. Nothing shows in the bay. It shows on the highway.

Ask your cal shop:

**"How many coats over the radar, and did the cal complete?"**



RED FLAG · REAR BUMPER, QUARTER PANEL

# Two radars, one each corner.

Blind spot and rear cross traffic radars live behind the rear cover on brackets in the quarter. Refinish counts. Ford: topcoat only, 12 mils max over the sensors. A bent bracket still completes the routine and still reads wrong on the road.

Ask your cal shop:

**"Both blind spot radars, and was the bracket checked?"**



RED FLAG · ALIGNMENT, SUSPENSION, TIRES

# Move the wheels, move the aim.

Thrust angle changes where the camera and radar point. Most makes require a recalibration after an alignment, and the steering angle sensor needs a reset. Bigger tires or a lift change radar height. Ford lists tire size change by name.

Ask your cal shop:

**"Alignment first, then calibration, and was the SAS reset?"**



THE ONE THING TO REMEMBER

# No code does not mean calibrated.

A scan finds what is broken. It does not prove the aim is right. Ford, May 2026: calibration is required on any ADAS repair "regardless of whether a DTC is present."

**The paperwork must show:**

- 1. OEM procedure by name**
- 2. Pre-scan and post-scan**
- 3. Aim values, before and after**
- 4. Bay, road, or both**
- 5. VIN, tech, date**
- 6. Faults found and what was done**



## HOW I WORK WITH YOUR SHOP

# Every calibration I recommend, your shop gets paid for.

If the carrier denies it after my documentation, you do not pay me. I write the OEM-cited rebuttal and it usually flips on the next round.

**Most calibration lines cost less than the tow that brings the car back.**

TEXT THE VAN  
**1-844-FIX-ADAS**

**Guide, line picker and checklist: [absoluteadas.com/estimator-guide](https://absoluteadas.com/estimator-guide)**